

PULSEBOARD · CONFIDENTIAL · JUNE 3, 2026

PRO Plan Churn Drivers

Executive Summary

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HEADLINE ANSWER

PRO plan churn is **early-lifecycle value failure at the \$199/mo tier**: 71% of cancellations are at that price, 86% occur within the first 6 months, and the median churned account exits after just 75 days. Critically, only 1 of 7 canceled subscriptions represents true platform abandonment — the other 6 accounts remain Pulseboard customers. The problem is not disengagement (churned accounts were 30% MORE active than retained ones) but perceived value relative to price, concentrated in months 0–3.

57%

of cancels in first
90 days

31.3%

cancel rate at
\$199/mo tier

6.7×

tenure gap
(505d active vs 75d
canceled)

6/7

canceled subs: account
still on Pulseboard

Key Findings

H4 — STRONGLY SUPPORTED

Short tenure is the sharpest risk signal

Median canceled tenure: **75 days** vs active: **505 days** (6.7× gap). Three cancels occurred in the first 30 days — all \$199/mo. Early-tenure risk is exclusively a \$199 tier phenomenon.

86% cancel in <6 months

57% cancel in <90 days

H2 — SUPPORTED (REFRAMED)

Price tier predicts cancellation

\$29/mo: **0%** cancel rate (9 active, 0 canceled). \$79/mo: **28.6%** (5 active, 2 canceled). \$199/mo: **31.3%** (11 active, 5 canceled). Zero billing delinquency — all cancels are voluntary opt-outs.

Canceled avg \$164.71/mo

Active avg \$113.80/mo

H1 — REFUTED (COUNTER-INTUITION)

Engagement does NOT predict cancellation

Accounts with a canceled sub averaged **51.0 events** vs retained accounts at **39.3 events** — churned accounts were +30% more active. All 5 event types higher in the has-canceled group. Do not build engagement-based churn alerts.

+30% activity in canceled group

STRUCTURAL FINDING

1 of 7 cancels = true platform exit

NKing Corp is the only account with no remaining subscriptions. KRoberts, PJohnson, OLopez, EFisher still hold active PRO subs — this is *subscription rationalization*, not churn. NKing filed 0 support tickets before leaving.

1/5 accounts = true exit

4/5 accounts still active

Recommendations

- 1 90-day onboarding intervention for \$199/mo accounts**
CS check-in at day 14, 30, and 60 for every new \$199/mo subscription. Surface ROI metrics in-product at each touchpoint.
- 2 Value-demonstration dashboard ("Your impact this month") for \$199/mo**
Active users who cancel aren't disengaged — they don't see ROI in numbers. Quantify the value they're getting before they make the opt-out decision.
- 3 Monitor the 4 rationalizing accounts over the next 90 days**
KRoberts, PJohnson, OLopez, EFisher still hold active subs. Track whether they rationalize further or stabilize. Targeted CS portfolio conversation recommended.
- 4 Investigate NKing Corp retrospectively**
Only true churner, filed 0 tickets before leaving. CS retrospective outreach needed to understand the silent departure pattern.
- X Do NOT build a support-escalation early-warning system**
H3 refuted. Ticket volume is not a leading indicator here. The highest-risk account (NKing Corp) filed zero tickets. Building this system would miss the exact customers you most need to catch.

CONTINUED — CAVEATS, VALIDATION & OPEN QUESTIONS

PRO Plan Churn Drivers — Caveats & Validation

Caveats & Limitations

Population size: n=7 canceled subscriptions — complete population descriptions, no sampling error, but findings cannot be statistically generalized to future cohorts.	Events coverage: Events table covers only 2025-03-07 to 2025-06-06 (~90 days). H1 tested on only 3 accounts with canceled subs — direction confirmed, coverage limited.
Subscription rationalization: Cannot distinguish deliberate consolidation from slow-exit first step for the 4 retained accounts. Requires 90-day follow-up monitoring.	Industry segmentation: n=1–4 per segment — untestable. Industry as a churn driver cannot be confirmed or refuted until customer base grows to 20+ per segment.
Mechanism unknown: No exit survey data exists. Whether the driver is ROI perception, competitive pricing, or feature gaps is inferred, not confirmed from voice-of-customer data.	Temporal confound: Newer \$199/mo accounts inherently have shorter tenure. Some early cancels may reflect cohort timing effects rather than pure value-failure dynamics.

Validation Summary

Check	Result	Status
Tenure threshold sensitivity (60d, 90d, 120d)	43% at 60d → 57% at 90d → 71% at 120d — monotonically increasing	ROBUST
Price gradient without \$199 tier	\$29=0% vs \$79=28.6% — gradient holds at lower tiers too	ROBUST
Billing failure as alternative explanation	0 unpaid invoices across 83 PRO invoices — fully ruled out	RULED OUT
Engagement decline as cause	Churned accounts +30% more active — direction opposite to hypothesis	REFUTED
Sample size / statistical significance	n=7 is complete population — no inferential stats needed; cannot generalize forward	CAVEAT
Industry as confounder	n=1–4 per segment — untestable at current scale	UNTESTABLE
Events window survivorship bias	Only 3 of 5 canceled accounts in events window — direction confirmed, coverage limited	CAVEAT

Open Questions

- **Will the 4 rationalizing accounts (KRoberts, PJohnson, OLopez, EFisher) cancel further in the next 90 days?**
— Requires monitoring; check-in recommended by 2026-09-01.

- **What drove NKing Corp's silent departure?** — Retrospective CS outreach should surface the mechanism (pricing, ROI, competition, product gap).
- **Does the \$29/mo tier truly have zero cancellation risk, or have there been no cancellations yet due to cohort age?** — Monitor cohort tenure distribution to check if \$29 accounts are simply newer.
- **What specific feature or outcome is missing from the \$199/mo value perception?** — Exit survey or NPS follow-up required to confirm the mechanism.
- **Can industry-level churn drivers be tested when base reaches 20+ accounts/segment?** — Flag for re-analysis in 2027 when Pulseboard reaches target scale.

Decision This Analysis Supports

Prioritize and design **retention interventions for \$199/mo accounts in their first 90 days**. The findings do not support broad win-back campaigns or engagement-monitoring investments. The at-risk profile is precise: \$199/mo, months 0–3. All CS and product resources should be concentrated here.